

SALVATION

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HOW DO YOU GET IT?

To be saved, one must believe on Jesus Christ. They must believe that He was who He said He was.

For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, **that whosoever believeth in him should not perish,** but have everlasting life. (John 3:16)

But that's not all, for Jesus warns us:

Thou believest that there is one God; thou doest well: **the devils also believe, and tremble.** (James 2:19)

So, what else separates us? What must we do to gain salvation? Well, throughout the entire Bible, repentance is required. In the Old Testament, mercy is offered to those who repent, and it's the same in the New.

If that nation, against whom I have pronounced, turn from their evil, I will repent of the evil that I thought to do unto them. (Jeremiah 18:8)

Repent ye therefore, and be converted, that your sins may be blotted out, when the times of refreshing shall come from the presence of the Lord; (Acts 3:19)

Testifying both to the Jews, and also to the Greeks, **repentance toward God, and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ.** (Acts 20:21)

And you will show your faith by your works. Faith is dead without works, and both faith and works rely on belief. No one can have faith in something they don't believe in.

But wilt thou know, O vain man, **that faith without works is dead?** (James 2:20)

And he that taketh not his cross, and followeth after me, is not worthy of me. (Matthew 10:38)

Then said Jesus unto his disciples, **If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.** (Matthew 16:24)

If ye love me, **keep my commandments.** (John 14:15)

If ye keep my commandments, ye shall abide in my love; even as I have kept my Father's commandments, and abide in his love. (John 15:10)

So, a believer—one who is saved—believes in Jesus, has repented, and tries to keep God's commandments and show their faith through their works.

With this in mind, what would it take to lose your salvation? Is it even possible?

FOR

ONCE SAVED, ALWAYS SAVED

2 Corinthians 1:22: Who hath also sealed us, and given the earnest of the Spirit in our hearts.

Thought For: This verse says Christians are sealed. God can't unseal someone.

Thought Against: I don't think it is God unsealing us. It is a Christian turning away from God —no longer repenting of their sin, no longer believing in God. Could a Christian "unseal" them self?

Ephesians 1:13: In whom ye also *trusted*, after that ye heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation: in whom also after that ye believed, ye were sealed with that holy Spirit of promise,

Thought For: This verse says that after you believe, you are sealed with the Holy Spirit. I don't think a Christian can be unsealed.

Thought Against: Is a Christian not being able be "unsealed" Biblical? Where is that in the Bible? What says a Christian can't be unsealed if they push God away?

John 3:16: For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.

Thought For: This verse says that "whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life." So if one can fall away, this verse is incorrect because that person believed but didn't get everlasting life.

Thought Against: The verse basically says: if you believe, you get everlasting life. So, while a person believes, they get eternal life. But if they fall away (no longer believe) they no longer have everlasting life. Because to get eternal life, you must believe. The verse doesn't say that if a person believes and falls away they still get eternal life.

Romans: 8:38-39: For I am persuaded, that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come, Nor height, nor depth, nor any other creature, shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.

Thought For: These verses basically say that NOTHING can separate us from God's love. Nothing.

Thought Against: Does it really say nothing? These verses don't say that WE can't separate ourselves from the love of God. All humans have a free will. So what happens if a former Christian pushes God away? What happens if a Christian chooses reject the free gift and no longer repent of their sin?

Romans 6:23: For the wages of sin is death; but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.

Thought For: You are given eternal life if you except the free gift. If you are given something, how can it be taken away?

Thought Against: Eternal life is the reward. To get the reward, you must except the free gift of salvation. It isn't God taking away your salvation, it is you throwing it away. It's like this: if you accept the free gift, you get life. You push it away, you get death.

Hebrews 5:8-9: Though he were a Son, yet learned he obedience by the things which he suffered; And being made perfect, he became the author of eternal salvation unto all them that obey him;

Thought For: This verse boldly claims that we are given eternal life. If we can lose our salvation, how is this verse still true?

Thought Against: It's still true because eternal life is only given to those that obey him (those who are true Christians), when someone dies, if they aren't a Christian (regardless of if they ever were) they no longer qualify as someone who obeys. So they don't receive the reward.

1 John 5:13: These things have I written unto you that believe on the name of the Son of God; that ye may know that ye have eternal life, and that ye may believe on the name of the Son of God.

Thought For: Once again we are promised eternal life. How is it possible for God to take that away?

Through Against: I don't think it is God taking it away. I think it is a person pushing it away, refusing the gift of salvation. And the verse clearly says it is addressed "unto you that believe on the name of the Son of God." If a Christian departs from the faith, he no longer is someone who believes on the Son of God, and so he won't receive the reward.

3 John 5:24: Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life.

Thought For: This specifically says that a believer will "not come into condemnation." So how could someone fall from the faith and go to hell, and this verse still be true?

Thought Against: It can be true because that person no longer "believeth on him." See, if that person believed and repented they wouldn't go to hell, but because they didn't believe (regardless of if they once did or not) they go to hell.

John 6:37: All that the Father giveth me shall come to me; and him that cometh to me I will in no wise cast out.

Thought For: God is very loving, and He will not cast us out. Thus, we can't lose our salvation.

Thought Against: He will not cast us out, true. But can we push Him away? It's the same with a person never saved; they have pushed God away. And since God has given them free will, that's their choice. I believe the same thing can happen to a Christian, they push God away and refuse to repent. God wouldn't cast them out if they came to Him, but they walked away from him.

John 11:25-26: Jesus said unto her, I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live: And whosoever liveth and believeth in me shall never die. Believest thou this?

Thought For: This says that if you believe in Jesus Christ you will have eternal life. What more do you need?

Thought Against: These two verses say that whoever believes in Jesus will not die. Once again, if you don't believe, your going to be condemned. If someone is born again, they get life. If they fall away, they have death—because this verse shows that only those that believe in Jesus get eternal life.

AGAINST

ONCE SAVED, ALWAYS SAVED

Hebrews 6:4-6: For *it is impossible for those who were once enlightened*, and have tasted of the heavenly gift, and were made partakers of the Holy Ghost, And have tasted the good word of God, and the powers of the world to come, *if they shall fall away, to renew them again unto repentance*; seeing they crucify to themselves the Son of God afresh, and put *him* to an open shame.

Context: The previous verses speak of perfecting the Christian.

Thought Against: Up until the first comma in verse 4, the Bible is saying that it is impossible for Christians to do something. We know that we are talking about Christians because most of verse 4 and all of verse 5 describe our subject. Verse 6 continues where verse 4 left off, saying it is impossible for a Christian to come back to the faith once they have left it the first time. As if this wasn't good enough, verse 6 continues to explain why this is impossible.

Thought For: These verses are saying it is impossible to leave the faith and come back because you would have to crucify Christ again.

2 Peter 1:5-11: And beside this, giving all diligence, add to your faith virtue; and to virtue knowledge; And to knowledge temperance; and to temperance patience; and to patience godliness; And to godliness brotherly kindness; and to brotherly kindness charity. For if these things be in you, and abound, they make you that ye shall neither be barren nor unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ. But he that lacketh these things is blind, and cannot see afar off, and hath forgotten that he was purged from his old sins. Wherefore the rather, brethren, *give diligence to make your calling and election sure: for if ye do these things, ye shall never fall:* For so an entrance shall be ministered unto you abundantly into the everlasting kingdom of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.

Thought: This passage is giving advice for keeping your "election sure."

Matthew 12:30-32: He that is not with me is against me; and he that gathereth not with me scattereth abroad. Wherefore I say unto you, All manner of sin and blasphemy shall be forgiven unto men: but the blasphemy against the Holy Ghost shall not be forgiven unto men. And whosoever speaketh a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him: but whosoever speaketh against the Holy Ghost, it shall not be forgiven him, neither in this world, neither in the world to come.

Thought: The unpardonable sin. Does not say that Christians are exempt.

Mark 3:28-29: Verily I say unto you, All sins shall be forgiven unto the sons of men, and blasphemies wherewith soever they shall blaspheme: But he that shall blaspheme against the Holy Ghost hath never forgiveness, but is in danger of eternal damnation:

Thought: Once again, this passage doesn't exempt Christians.

Luke 12:10: And whosoever shall speak a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him: but unto him that blasphemeth against the Holy Ghost it shall not be forgiven.

Thought: Repeated a third time.

1 Timothy 1:19-20: Holding faith, and a good conscience; which some having put away concerning faith have made shipwreck: Of whom is Hymenaeus and Alexander; whom I have delivered unto Satan, that they may learn not to blaspheme.

Thought: This is up for interpretation, but may be speaking of Hymenaeus losing his salvation.

Luke 8:4-15: And when much people were gathered together, and were come to him out of every city, he spake by a parable: A sower went out to sow his seed: and as he sowed, some fell by the way side; and it was trodden down, and the fowls of the air devoured it. And some fell upon a rock; and as soon as it was sprung up, it withered away, because it lacked moisture. And some fell among thorns; and the thorns sprang up with it, and choked it. And other fell on good ground, and sprang up, and bare fruit an hundredfold. And when he had said these things, he cried, He that hath ears to hear, let him hear. And his disciples asked him, saying, What might this parable be? And he said, Unto you it is given to know the mysteries of the kingdom of God: but to others in parables; that seeing they might not see, and hearing they might not understand. Now the parable is this: The seed is the word of God. Those by the way side are they that hear; then cometh the devil, and taketh away the word out of their hearts, lest they should believe and be saved. They on the rock are they, which, when they hear, receive the word with joy; and these have no root, which for a while believe, and in time of temptation fall away. And that which fell among thorns are they, which, when they have heard, go forth, and are choked with cares and riches and pleasures of this life, and bring no fruit to perfection. But that on the good ground are they, which in an honest and good heart, having heard the word, keep it, and bring forth fruit with patience.

Thought: Parable of the seeds. Jesus appears to be saying that Christians can fall away from the faith.

Hebrews 3:6: But Christ as a son over his own house; whose house are we, if we hold fast the confidence and the rejoicing of the hope firm unto the end.

Thought: Seems to possibly be a condition for receiving eternal life.

Hebrews 3:12-14: Take heed, brethren, lest there be in any of you an evil heart of unbelief, in departing from the living God. But exhort one another daily, while it is called To day; lest any of you be hardened through the deceitfulness of sin. For we are made partakers of Christ, if we hold the beginning of our confidence stedfast unto the end;

Thought: Again, the warning to stay steadfast to the end.

2 Peter 2:21: For it had been better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than, after they have known it, to turn from the holy commandment delivered unto them.

Thought: Very powerful statement, assuming that righteousness here means the faith.

Matthew 10:22: And ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake: but he that endureth to the end shall be saved.

Thought: Interesting note, might be saying that those that fall before the finish do not receive the prize.

Matthew 24:13: But he that shall endure unto the end, the same shall be saved.

Thought: The same warning. Run the race to the end, faithfully.

Mark 13:13: And ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake: but he that shall endure unto the end, the same shall be saved.

Thought: Run the race faithfully.

1 Corinthians 1:8: Even as the testimony of Christ was confirmed in you: So that ye come behind in no gift; waiting for the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ: Who shall also confirm you unto the end, that ye may be blameless in the day of our Lord Jesus Christ.

Thought: Possibly warning us to stay strong until the end.

Hebrew 6:11-12: And we desire that every one of you do shew the same diligence to the full assurance of hope unto the end: That ye be not slothful, but followers of them who through faith and patience inherit the promises.

Thought: Is this saying to run the race faithfully to the end to receive the reward?

1 Peter 1:8-9: Whom having not seen, ye love; in whom, though now ye see him not, yet believing, ye rejoice with joy unspeakable and full of glory: Receiving the end of your faith, even the salvation of your souls.

Thought: Is this saying that the end of our faith is salvation?

Revelation 2:26: And he that overcometh, and keepeth my works unto the end, to him will I give power over the nations: And he shall rule them with a rod of iron; as the vessels of a potter shall they be broken to shivers: even as I received of my Father. And I will give him the morning star.

Thought: The reward of the faithful.

John 8:31: As he spake these words, many believed on him. Then said Jesus to those Jews which believed on him, If ye continue in my word, then are ye my disciples indeed;

Thought: Jesus seems to be making a deal here. He says that you must "continue in my words" and you will "be my disciples."

Romans 11:17-22: And if some of the branches be broken off, and thou, being a wild olive tree, wert grafted in among them, and with them partakest of the root and fatness of the olive tree; Boast not against the branches. But if thou boast, thou bearest not the root, but the root thee. Thou wilt say then, The branches were broken off, that I might be grafted in. Well; because of unbelief they were broken off, and thou standest by faith. Be not highminded, but fear: For if God spared not the natural branches, take heed lest he also spare not thee. Behold therefore the goodness and severity of God: on them which fell, severity; but toward thee, goodness, if thou continue in his goodness: otherwise thou also shalt be cut off.

Thought: This clearly says that you must continue in the faith, or be cut off. As a gentile, how can you be cut off unless you first be grafted in? The only debate here, is what being grafted in means.

1 Timothy 4:1: Now the Spirit speaketh expressly, that in the latter times some shall depart from the faith, giving heed to seducing spirits, and doctrines of devils;

Thought: How much clearer can the Bible be?

Matthew 18:23-35: Therefore is the kingdom of heaven likened unto a certain king, which would take account of his servants. And when he had begun to reckon, one was brought unto him, which owed him ten thousand talents. But forasmuch as he had not to pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, and his wife, and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made. The servant therefore fell down, and worshipped him, saying, Lord, have patience with me, and I will pay thee all. Then the lord of that servant was moved with compassion, and loosed him, and forgave him the debt. But the same servant went out, and found one of his fellowservants, which owed him an hundred pence: and he laid hands on him, and took him by the throat, saying, Pay me that thou owest. And his fellowservant fell down at his feet, and besought him, saying, Have patience with me, and I will pay thee all. And he would not: but went and cast him into prison, till he should pay the debt. So when his fellowservants saw what was done, they were very sorry, and came and told unto their lord all that was done. Then his lord, after that he had called him, said unto him, O thou wicked servant, I forgave thee all that debt, because thou desiredst me: Shouldest not thou also have had compassion on thy fellowservant, even as I had pity on thee? And his lord was wroth, and delivered him to the tormentors, till he should pay all that was due unto him. So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.

Thought: Here, we are warned to forgive others, or we ourselves will not be forgiven. In the parable, the servant was already forgiven his debts. So does that mean that a Christian, who has already had their debt forgiven, can have that forgiveness taken away if they forgive not other?

Hebrews 10:26: For if we sin wilfully after that we have received the knowledge of the truth, there remaineth no more sacrifice for sins,

Thought: A very scary verse.

Matthew 5:13: Ye are the salt of the earth: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be salted? it is thenceforth good for nothing, but to be cast out, and to be trodden under foot of men.

Thought: Are the unsaved the "salt of the earth"? No, so what does this verse mean when it speaks of the salt losing its savor?

Revelation 3:5: He that overcometh, the same shall be clothed in white raiment; and I will not blot out his name out of the book of life, but I will confess his name before my Father, and before his angels.

Thought: Run the race to the end?

Revelation 22:19: And if any man shall take away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part out of the book of life, and out of the holy city, and from the things which are written in this book.

Thought: This doesn't sound like it excludes Christians. Also, modern bibles constantly add to the Bible, as well as remove, and change. (See THE CORRUPT VERSIONS, by Samuel Swartz.)

2 Timothy 2:11-13: It is a faithful saying: For if we be dead with him, we shall also live with him: If we suffer, we shall also reign with him: if we deny him, he also will deny us: If we believe not, yet he abideth faithful: he cannot deny himself.

Thought: Does this warning only go for the unsaved? Can a Christian fall from the faith by denying Jesus?

Ezekiel 18:26: When a righteous man turneth away from his righteousness, and committeth iniquity, and dieth in them; for his iniquity that he hath done shall he die.

Thought: Says that a righteous man can turn from righteousness.

NEITHER

FOR NOR AGAINST ONCE SAVED, ALWAYS SAVED

Mark 4:22: For false Christs and false prophets shall rise, and shall shew signs and wonders, to seduce, if it were possible, even the elect.

Thought For: It says that sign and wonder will be done and they will be so convincing that they would deceive the elect, if it were possible that is.

Thought Against: Says that the signs and wonders will, if it were possible (saying nothing about weather or not it is possible) deceive the elect.